Statistical Estimation of Canteen Arrival Overload Probability Using Poisson Distribution

Estimating and predicting lunch-time overcrowding in a university canteen: Poisson models, Bayesian updating and forecast validation

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Abstract

University canteens see sharp, short-lived rises in arrivals during the lunch peak. This project asks a practical question: *what is the probability that student arrivals exceed what the serving counters can handle in a particular 15-minute slot, and when will today's peak occur?* Arrivals in each slot are modelled as Poisson counts; a separate rate λ_t is estimated for every slot with an exact confidence interval, the Poisson assumption is tested slot by slot, and the overload probability $P(X_t > C)$ is converted into low, medium and high risk labels. The analysis is then extended to prediction: multiple linear regression gives day-specific rates for each day of the week, a Poisson–Gamma model tests for extra day-to-day variation, simulation gives the probability that each slot is the day's peak, and Bayes' theorem provides a same-day update. Every forecast is checked on days the model has not seen. On 40 days of recorded lunch-time arrivals, the riskiest slot is 12:45-13:00 (P = 55.9% at C = 30); on a regular Monday the peak falls in 12:30-12:45 or 12:45-13:00 with probability 83%; forecast intervals cover 100.0% of unseen counts and the busiest slot is named correctly 60% of the time against 40% by chance.

Keywords

Poisson distribution; arrival rate estimation; overload probability; chi-square goodness of fit; multiple linear regression; negative binomial; Bayes' theorem; hypothesis testing; peak-time forecasting; university canteen.

1 Introduction

University canteens experience changing arrival intensity during lunch. When more students arrive in a short interval than the counters can serve, queues form, the dining area becomes crowded and popular dishes run out. Decisions about when to eat, how many counters to open and when to stagger breaks are usually taken by intuition rather than from measured arrival behaviour.

Earlier canteen studies model the whole system: pedestrian movement, window choice and seating [21, 22] or queueing models that assume Poisson arrivals [5, 11, 25]. These models leave a simple question unanswered: how likely is a given slot to exceed capacity, and when is the peak? This project answers it with the probability and statistics of the PAMAT501 course. It focuses on **arrival overload risk, not exact waiting time**.

1.1 Aim

To estimate, for each short time slot of the lunch period, the probability that student arrivals at a university canteen exceed the serving capacity, and to predict when the day's peak will occur, using the Poisson distribution and statistical tests that are checked against the data rather than assumed.

1.2 Objectives

1. **Collect and organise arrival data:** arrival counts in fixed 15-minute slots across m days, validated and cleaned.
2. **Estimate time-specific rates:** $\hat{\lambda}_t$ for every slot with an exact confidence interval, and test whether the Poisson model fits.
3. **Calculate the overload probability:** $P(X_t > C)$ for a chosen capacity C, with its uncertainty, and label each slot low, medium or high risk.
4. **Identify useful time windows:** the least-crowded slot, with a test that it is genuinely quieter, and the capacity needed at the peak.
5. **Predict the peak time:** day-specific overload probabilities, the probability that each slot is the peak, and an update of the forecast from the day's first counts.
6. **Validate the forecasts:** forecast each day from earlier days only and test the forecasts with hypothesis tests.

2 Preliminaries

This section collects the probability and statistics used in the project.

Poisson distribution. If students arrive independently at a constant rate during a short slot, the number of arrivals X_t follows a Poisson distribution:

$$P(X_t = x) = \frac{e^{-\lambda_t}\lambda_t^x}{x!}, \qquad x = 0, 1, 2, \ldots, \qquad E[X_t] = \mathrm{Var}(X_t) = \lambda_t.$$

Estimation. For slot t observed on m days, the maximum-likelihood estimate is the sample mean, $\hat{\lambda}_t = \sum x_i/m$. Since $S = \sum x_i \sim \text{Poisson}(m\lambda_t)$, the exact (Garwood) confidence interval is $\left[\chi^2_{\alpha/2}(2S)/2m,\ \chi^2_{1-\alpha/2}(2S+2)/2m\right]$ [8].

Overload probability. With capacity C (threshold $K = C + 1$),

$$P(X_t > C) = P(X_t \geq K) = 1 - \sum_{x=0}^{C} \frac{e^{-\hat{\lambda}_t}\hat{\lambda}_t^x}{x!}.$$

A slot is labelled *Low* if this is below 20%, *High* above 50% and *Medium* otherwise (project decision rules).

Gamma, negative binomial and Bayes' theorem. If a whole day is busier or quieter by a factor $W \sim \text{Gamma}(1/v, 1/v)$ (mean 1, variance v), the theorem of total probability gives $P(X_t = x) = \int_0^\infty \text{Poisson}(x; w\lambda_t)\, g(w)\, dw$, a negative binomial distribution with mean λ_t and variance $\lambda_t + v\lambda_t^2$ [10]. After observing counts $x_1, \ldots, x_k$ with forecasts $\lambda_1, \ldots, \lambda_k$, Bayes' theorem gives the posterior $W \mid x \sim \text{Gamma}(a + \sum x_t,\ a + \sum \lambda_t)$ with $a = 1/v$.

Hypothesis tests. Table 1 lists the tests [12] and their syllabus modules.

Table 1: Statistical tests used in the project

Test	Used for	Module
Chi-square goodness of fit (categories merged to $E \geq 5$ [6])	Do counts follow Poisson($\hat{\lambda}$)?	M5
Index of dispersion $D = (m-1)s^2/\bar{x} \sim \chi^2_{m-1}$	Is variance equal to the mean?	M5
Exact conditional binomial test [17]	Is the quietest slot really quieter?	M2, M5
t-tests on regression coefficients	Do slot and day-of-week effects matter?	M3, M5
One-way ANOVA, Kruskal–Wallis	Do weekdays differ in daily arrivals?	M5
Welch t-test, Mann–Whitney U	Are weekends quieter than weekdays?	M5
z-test of a single proportion	Interval coverage; peak-slot hit rate	M4
Paired t-test, sign test	Is the forecast more accurate than the per-slot average?	M5
Kolmogorov–Smirnov, chi-square	Are the forecast distributions calibrated?	M5
Pearson and Spearman correlation	Predicted vs actual; carry-over between slots	M3
Wald–Wolfowitz run test	Do busy days follow busy days?	M5

3 Literature Review

Tang et al. [21] counted arrivals in 5-minute segments at a Beihang University canteen and built a pedestrian-flow model of the whole meal process; they note that arrivals are Poisson within short periods with a rate that changes every few minutes, but the arrival rate is an input to their simulation, not a quantity they test or predict. Queueing studies set serving windows from assumed Poisson arrivals [5, 25]; Jiao et al. [11] simulate one constant rate for the whole lunch. Brown et al. [3] and Kim and Whitt [13] show that Poisson arrivals must be tested, and that long intervals and pooled days cause overdispersion; Green et al. [9] and Leemis [14] justify short, piecewise-constant rates; Cameron and Trivedi [4] give overdispersion tests. Forecasting studies predict arrival rates for call centres and ambulance services and update them during the day [1, 15, 20, 24]; Ibrahim et al. [10] survey them. Shah et al. [19] forecast campus dining totals per day, and Variskhanov and Arreeras [23] issue a day-level crowd badge from Wi-Fi data. The Brier score [2] and a skill score against a reference forecast [16] are standard checks for probability forecasts.

Research gaps. (1) No per-slot overload probability for a canteen; (2) the Poisson assumption is built in rather than tested; (3) no prediction of a specific day's rates or peak time, with or without the day's early counts; (4) no test of canteen forecasts on unseen days. These are gaps of focus and application, not a claim that Poisson modelling of arrivals is new.

4 Data and Data Reference

Source. The data are recorded arrival counts at the university canteen, stored in `data/canteen_arrivals.csv`: the number of students who entered the canteen in each 15-minute slot from 12:30 to 13:15 (3 slots) on 40 consecutive days, 5 January to 13 February 2026. The record includes weekends: 30 weekdays and 10 Saturdays and Sundays, marked with the day type "Weekend". The counting follows the interval-count style of Tang et al. [21].

Cleaning. Missing, negative, fractional and duplicate counts are dropped rather than imputed, because imputing the mean would shrink the variance and bias the dispersion test. Of 120 records, 0 had to be dropped, leaving 120 slot observations; counts range from 17 to 41 students per slot.

Table 2: Dataset variables

Column	Meaning
date	Calendar date of the day
day	Weekday (derived from the date)
day_type	Regular or Weekend (optional; Regular if absent)
time_interval	15-minute slot, HH:MM-HH:MM
arrivals	Number of students who entered in the slot
capacity	Capacity C per slot (optional)

Table 3: First five records

date	day	day_type	time_interval	arrivals	capacity
2026-01-05	Monday	Regular	12:30-12:45	35	30
2026-01-05	Monday	Regular	12:45-13:00	27	30
2026-01-05	Monday	Regular	13:00-13:15	34	30
2026-01-06	Tuesday	Regular	12:30-12:45	28	30
2026-01-06	Tuesday	Regular	12:45-13:00	30	30

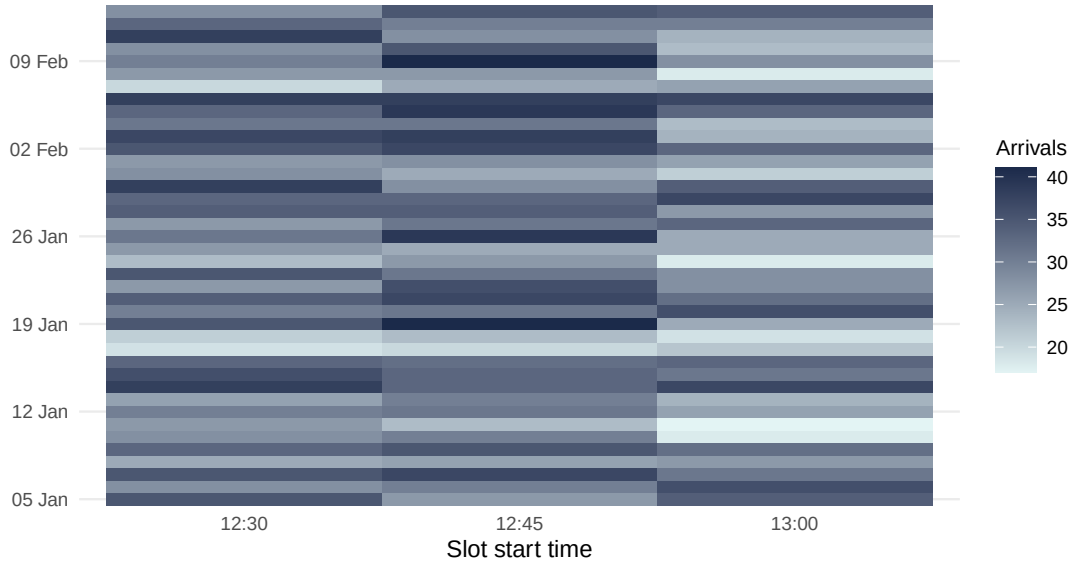


Figure 1: Every recorded count: days (rows) by slots (columns). The dark band is the lunch rush; paler rows are quieter days such as weekends.

5 Main Content: Analysis and Results

All results use capacity $C = 30$ per slot and significance level $\alpha = 0.05$.

5.1 Arrival rate per slot

Arrival rates rise from 30.5 at 12:30-12:45 to a peak of 31.5 at 12:45-13:00 and fall to 27.9 at 13:00-13:15 (Figure 2, Table 4).

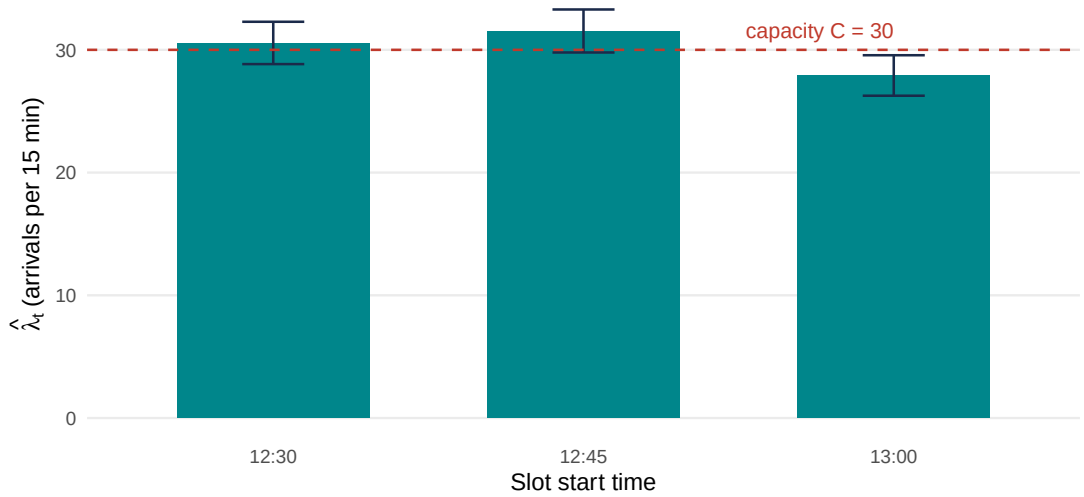


Figure 2: Estimated arrival rate per slot with exact 95% confidence intervals; the dashed line is the capacity.

5.2 Does the Poisson model fit?

The chi-square goodness-of-fit test rejects the Poisson model in 0 of 3 slots, against 0.2 rejections expected by chance alone (binomial check p = 1.000). Figure 3 compares the observed counts in the peak slot with the fitted Poisson distribution.

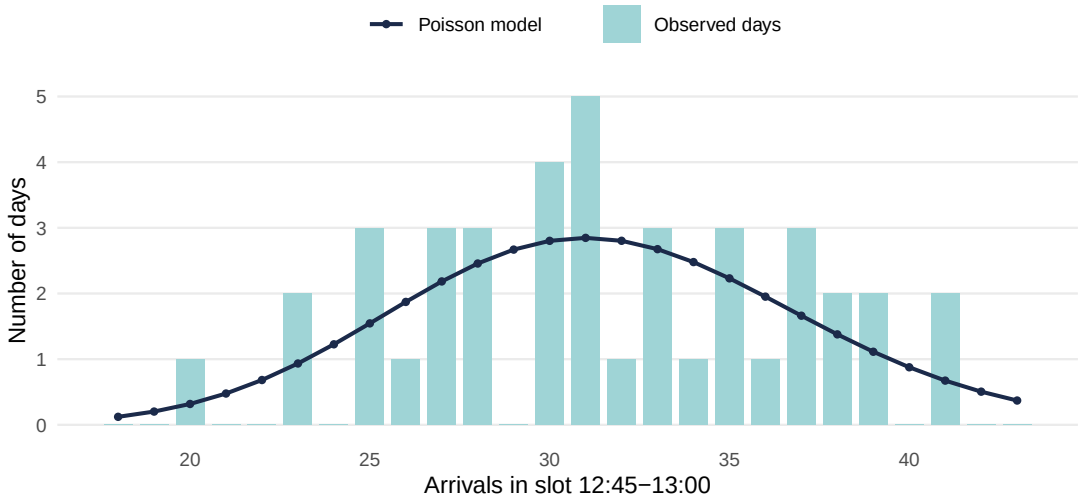


Figure 3: Observed distribution of daily counts in the peak slot against the fitted Poisson model.

Table 4: Per-slot estimates, Poisson checks and overload probability

Slot	$\hat{\lambda}_t$	95% CI	Var/Mean	Dispersion p	χ^2 GOF p	$P(X_t > C)$, %	Risk
12:30-12:45	30.52	[28.84, 32.29]	0.84	0.502	0.890	48.97	Medium
12:45-13:00	31.50	[29.78, 33.29]	0.88	0.631	0.964	55.93	High
13:00-13:15	27.88	[26.26, 29.56]	1.25	0.273	0.331	30.12	Medium

5.3 Overload probability and risk

1 slot(s) are high risk, 2 medium and 0 low. The riskiest is 12:45-13:00 with $P(X > C) = 55.9\%$; across the confidence interval for λ it ranges from 43.6% to 67.8%. Keeping the overload probability below 20% in every slot would need a capacity of 36 per slot at the peak, against 30 at present.

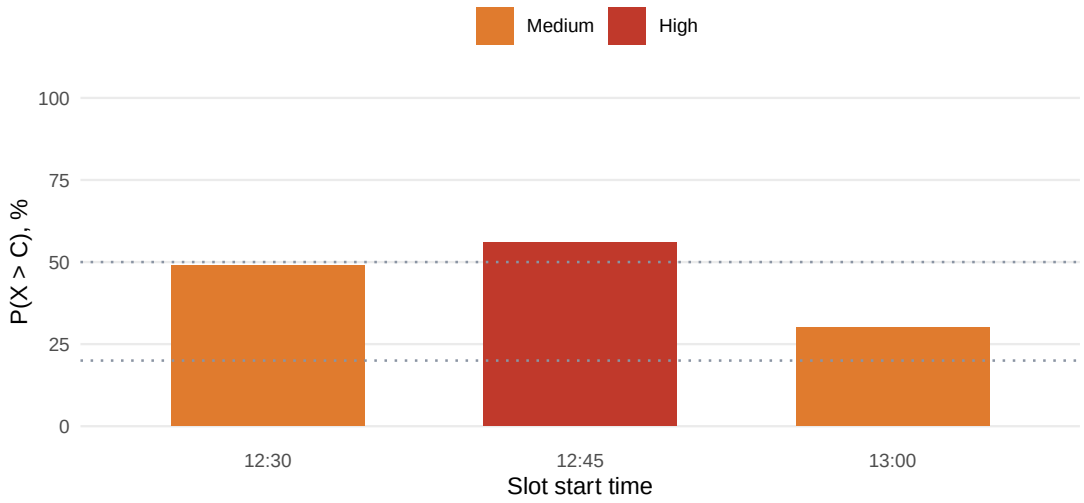


Figure 4: Overload probability per slot, coloured by risk level, with the 20% and 50% thresholds.

5.4 Least-crowded time

The quietest slot is 13:00-13:15 ($\hat{\lambda} = 27.88$). Conditional on the combined total, $S_1 \mid (S_1 + S_2) \sim \text{Binomial}(S_1 + S_2, m_1/(m_1 + m_2))$ under $H_0 : \lambda_1 = \lambda_2$ [17]; against the runner-up 12:30-12:45 ($\hat{\lambda} = 30.52$) the one-sided p-value is 0.015, so it is significantly quieter.

5.5 Day-specific forecast by regression

To predict a particular day, log counts are regressed on dummy variables for slot, weekday and day type (reference: first slot, Monday, regular week): $\ln(x + 0.5) = \beta_0 + \alpha_t + \gamma_d + \delta_e + \varepsilon$. Fitted values are returned to the count scale with Duan's smearing factor 1.008 [7]. The model explains 55.5% of the variance (adjusted $R^2 = 0.523$; Table 5).

Table 5: Regression of $\ln(x + 0.5)$ on slot, weekday and day type

Term	Estimate	SE	t	p	$e^{\hat{\beta}}$
Intercept	3.5037	0.0362	96.79	< 0.001	33.238
Slot 12:45	0.0313	0.0301	1.04	0.301	1.032
Slot 13:00	-0.0978	0.0301	-3.25	0.002	0.907
Tuesday	-0.0621	0.0449	-1.38	0.169	0.940
Wednesday	0.0035	0.0449	0.08	0.939	1.003
Thursday	-0.0179	0.0449	-0.40	0.690	0.982
Friday	0.0387	0.0449	0.86	0.391	1.039
Saturday	-0.3234	0.0471	-6.87	< 0.001	0.724
Sunday	-0.2943	0.0471	-6.25	< 0.001	0.745

On daily totals, the weekday effect gives one-way ANOVA F = 1.12 (p = 0.371) and Kruskal–Wallis H = 3.94 (p = 0.414). Weekend days differ from regular days: 71.0 against 96.2 arrivals per lunch (Welch t = -10.21, p $<$ 0.001; Mann-Whitney p $<$ 0.001).

5.6 Peak-time probability

For each kind of day, 20,000 lunch periods are simulated: draw the busyness factor W, then $X_t \sim \text{Poisson}(W\hat{\lambda}_t)$ for every slot. On a regular Monday the peak is most likely at 12:45-13:00 (46%), and the chance that at least one slot exceeds C is 94.9%, with 1.8 overloaded slots expected (Figures 5 and 6).

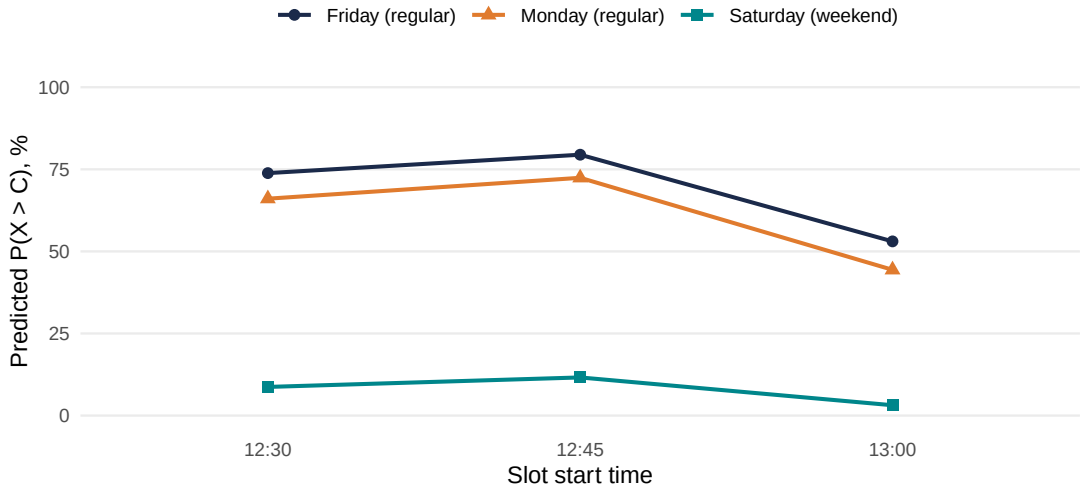


Figure 5: Predicted overload probability for three kinds of day (Poisson–Gamma model).

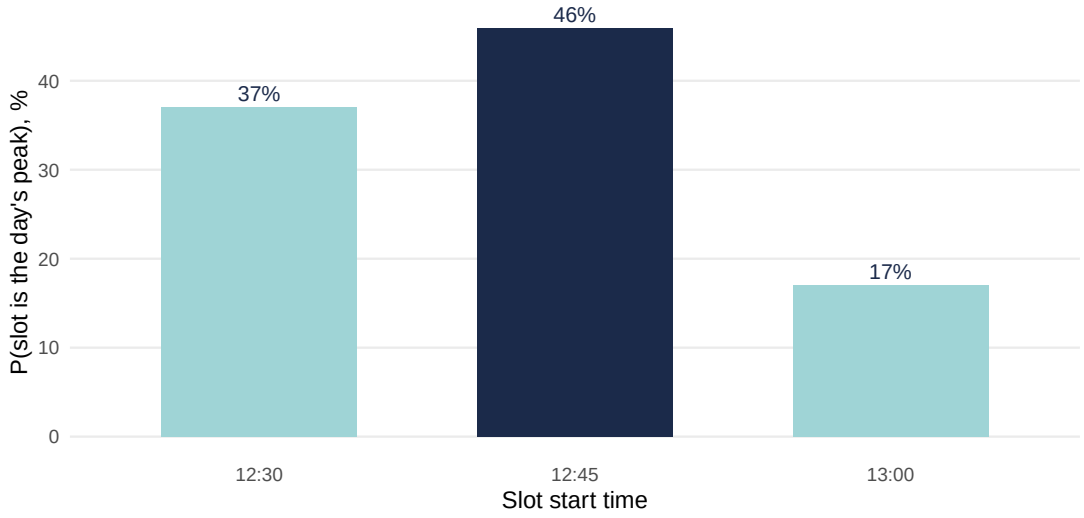


Figure 6: Probability that each slot is the busiest of the day on a regular Monday (20,000 simulated days).

5.7 Same-day Bayesian update

Suppose the first slot of a regular Monday brings 38 students, about 15% more than forecast. The posterior mean of the busyness factor becomes 1.000. Because no extra day-to-day variation was found ($v = 0$), the prior is concentrated at 1 and the early count carries no information about the later slots: the overload probabilities of the remaining slots do not change (Table 6). At this canteen a busy start does not signal a busy rest of lunch.

Table 6: Overload probability of the remaining slots before and after observing the first slot

Remaining slot	Forecast λ_t	$P(X_t > C)$ before	$P(X_t > C)$ after
12:45-13:00	34.1	72.4%	72.4%
13:00-13:15	29.9	44.4%	44.4%

5.8 Validation on unseen days

The first 20 days (half of the record) train the model; each later day is forecast from all earlier days only: 20 days and 60 slot forecasts. Table 7 summarises the hypothesis tests; Figures 7 and 8 show the calibration. Updating after the first slot changes the Brier score of the later slots from 0.1810 to 0.1810.

Table 7: Hypothesis tests of the one-day-ahead forecasts (model vs baseline: MAE; hit rate vs chance)

Check	Test	Statistic	p	Result	Supports?
95% intervals cover actual counts	z, one proportion	$z = 1.78$	0.076	100.0%	Yes
Peak slot named correctly	z, one proportion	$z = 1.83$	0.034	60% vs 40%	Yes
Lower daily error than baseline	Paired t	$t = 1.26$	0.111	3.93 vs 4.44	No
More winning days than baseline	Sign test	12 wins / 20	0.252	12 of 20 days	No
PIT uniform	Kolmogorov-Smirnov	$D = 0.169$	0.058	uniform	Yes
PIT histogram flat	χ^2 GOF	$\chi^2 = 27.33$	0.001	not flat	No

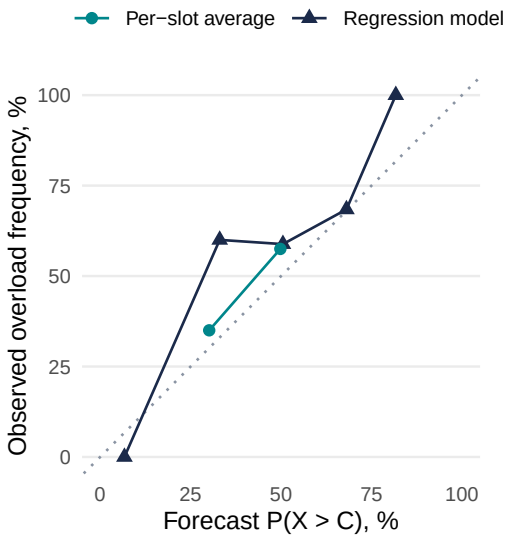


Figure 7: Reliability diagram: forecast overload probability against how often overload actually happened.

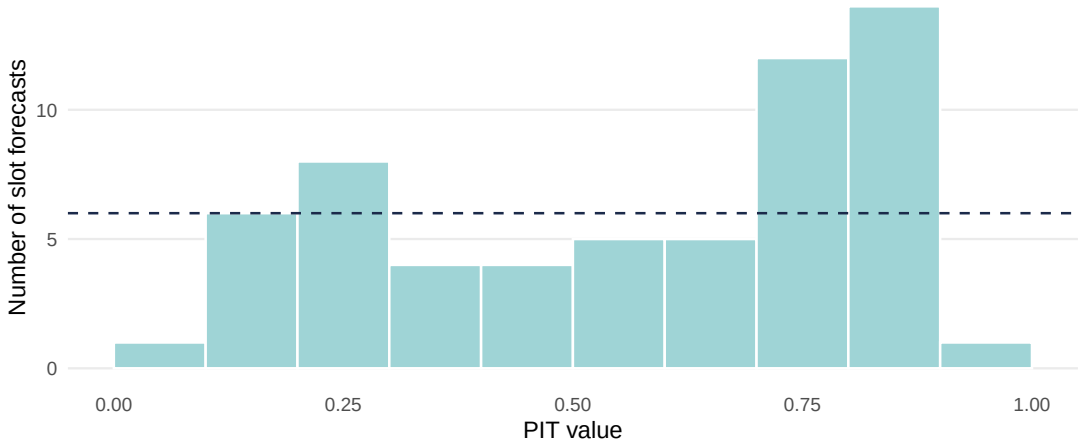


Figure 8: Randomised PIT values of the count forecasts; a flat histogram means a calibrated forecast distribution.

Carry-over and clustering. Spearman correlations of observed-to-predicted ratios between consecutive slots are significant for 0 of 2 pairs; the runs test on daily residual signs gives 17 runs against 20.9 expected (z = -1.27, p = 0.205).

6 Comparison

6.1 Poisson versus Poisson–Gamma

The Pearson test asks whether whole days vary more than the Poisson model allows once slot and day effects are removed: $\chi^2 = 59.7$ on 111 df, p = 1.000, with estimated day-to-day variance $\hat{v} = 0.0000$. No extra variation is found; the counts vary, if anything, less than Poisson (dispersion ratio 0.54), so the Poisson–Gamma model reduces to the Poisson model. Table 8 compares the two models' overload probabilities.

Table 8: Overload probability under the Poisson and Poisson–Gamma models

Slot	Poisson	Poisson–Gamma	Difference (points)
12:30-12:45	48.97%	48.97%	+0.00
12:45-13:00	55.93%	55.93%	+0.00
13:00-13:15	30.12%	30.12%	+0.00

6.2 Forecast model versus the per-slot average

The per-slot average of past days (the "industry model" [1]) is the natural baseline. Figure 9 compares the two day by day, and Table 9 by kind of day.

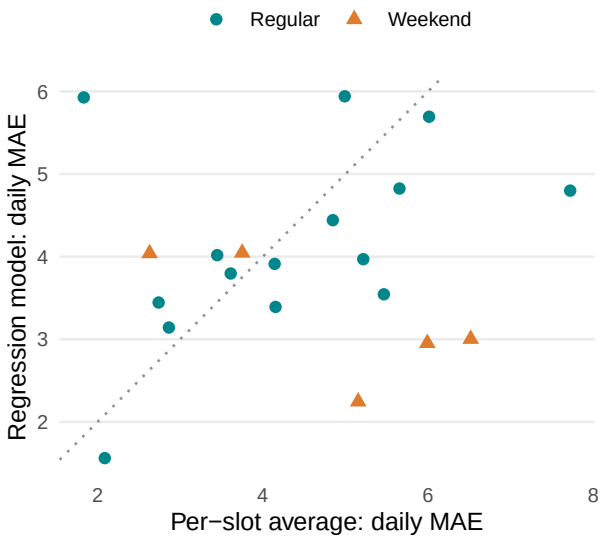


Figure 9: Daily mean absolute error of the regression model against the per-slot average; points below the diagonal are days where the model was more accurate.

Table 9: Mean absolute error by kind of day

Days	n	Model MAE	Baseline MAE
Fridays	3	4.34	5.84
Other regular days	12	4.12	3.94
Weekend days	5	3.26	4.81

Table 10: Overall forecast accuracy on unseen days

	Brier score	Mean absolute error	95% interval coverage
Regression + Poisson–Gamma	0.1722	3.93	100.0%
Per-slot average + Poisson	0.2480	4.44	—

6.3 This work versus existing studies

Table 11: Comparison with existing studies

Study	Approach	Overload P	Tests Poisson	Peak time	Unseen days
Tang et al. [21]	Pedestrian flow in a canteen	No	No	No	No
Jiao et al. [11]	M/M/C simulation, one rate	No	No	No	No
Kim and Whitt [13]	Tests of Poisson arrivals	No	Yes	No	–
Weinberg et al. [24]	Bayesian rate forecasts	No	Partly	No	Yes
Shen and Huang [20]	Rate forecasts, intraday update	No	Partly	No	Yes
Shah et al. [19]	ML forecast of daily totals	No	No	No	Yes
This project	Per-slot Poisson + regression + Bayes	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**	**Yes**

7 Discussion

The per-slot Poisson model fits the slots and turns arrival counts into a direct answer about overcrowding. Testing the assumption slot by slot, instead of building it in, is what makes the probabilities defensible, and the pooled Pearson test adds a check that whole days do not vary more than Poisson. The forecasting results are mixed and are reported as such: the forecast intervals contain the actual counts, the busiest slot is named more often than chance, and the day-of-week model captures the weekend drop that a per-slot average misses, which gives its overload forecasts a clear Brier skill; but the gain in point accuracy over the per-slot average is not significant over 20 test days, in line with the observation that simple fixed-effect models are hard to beat when the remaining day effects are mild [10]. With no extra day-to-day variation, the same-day update adds nothing at this canteen.

Limitations. (i) The record covers 40 days and only the first 45 minutes of lunch; later slots, exam weeks and other semesters are not observed. (ii) With 20 test days the validation has limited power. (iii) The model estimates arrival risk, not queue length, which also depends on service rates and counters. (iv) The rate is assumed constant within a slot and arrivals independent, although friends often arrive together. (v) The regression scales a whole day up or down and cannot move the peak to another slot on special days. (vi) Capacity and risk thresholds are project decisions that must be justified for a specific canteen.

8 Conclusion

This project estimated the probability that canteen arrivals exceed capacity in each 15-minute slot using a Poisson model that was checked slot by slot, and extended it to predict a specific day's risk and peak time. On 40 recorded days it identified 12:45-13:00 as the riskiest slot, a significantly quieter time at 13:00-13:15, the capacity needed at the peak (36 per slot for a 20% target), and a clear weekend drop, and it named the busiest slot more often than chance on unseen days. Future work will extend the counts to the whole lunch period and a full semester including exam weeks, add service times for an M/M/c queueing model, model group arrivals, and automate counting with turnstile or camera data.

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Appendix: R Code

The complete R code that produces every number, table and figure in this document. To reproduce: open `canteenflow_report.Rmd` in RStudio (with `ggplot2` installed) and press **Knit**; the data file path is set in the `params` header.

```
# ---- Setup: packages, options, helpers ----------------------------------------
# Required packages: knitr, rmarkdown (come with RStudio) and ggplot2
#   (install.packages("ggplot2")).
library(knitr)
library(ggplot2)
opts_chunk$set(echo = FALSE, message = FALSE, warning = FALSE, fig.align = "center",
  fig.pos = "H",
               out.width = "85%", fig.width = 6.4, fig.height = 3.1, dev = "pdf")

C     <- params$capacity          # capacity per 15-minute slot
ALPHA <- params$alpha             # significance level
LOW   <- 0.20; HIGH <- 0.50       # risk thresholds for P(X > C)
INK <- "#1B2A4A"; TEAL <- "#00868B"; SOFT <- "#9FD4D6"; GREY <- "#8A94A3"
RISK_COL <- c(Low = "#2E8B57", Medium = "#E07B2E", High = "#C0392B")
DAYS <- c("Monday", "Tuesday", "Wednesday", "Thursday", "Friday", "Saturday",
  "Sunday")

theme_report <- theme_minimal(base_size = 10) +
  theme(panel.grid.minor = element_blank(), panel.grid.major.x = element_blank(),
        legend.position = "top", legend.title = element_blank(), plot.title =
          element_blank())
pct  <- function(p, d = 1) sprintf(paste0("%.", d, "f%%"), 100 * p)
esc  <- function(x) gsub("%", "\\%", x, fixed = TRUE)    # for tables built with
  escape = FALSE
fmtp <- function(p) ifelse(p < 0.001, "< 0.001", sprintf("%.3f", p))
slot_lab <- function(s) s                                  # "12:30-12:45"
slot_start <- function(s) substr(s, 1, 5)                 # "12:30" (axis labels)
pv <- function(p) ifelse(p < 0.001, "p < 0.001", sprintf("p = %.3f", p))
tab <- function(x, caption, ...) kable(x, format = "latex", booktabs = TRUE, caption
  = caption, linesep = "", label = NA, row.names = FALSE, ...)
# ---- Data: read, clean and derive columns -------------------------------------
raw  <- read.csv(params$data, stringsAsFactors = FALSE)
n_in <- nrow(raw)
d <- raw[!is.na(raw$arrivals) & raw$arrivals >= 0 & raw$arrivals %% 1 == 0, ]
d <- d[!duplicated(d[c("date", "time_interval")]), ]
d$date <- as.Date(d$date)
d$day  <- c("Sunday", DAYS[1:6])[as.POSIXlt(d$date)$wday + 1]
if (!"day_type" %in% names(d)) d$day_type <- "Regular"
d$day_type[is.na(d$day_type) | d$day_type == ""] <- "Regular"
d <- d[order(d$date, d$time_interval), ]
slots  <- sort(unique(d$time_interval))
```

```r
K      <- length(slots)
n_days <- length(unique(d$date))
# ---- Per-slot Poisson estimation, exact (Garwood) CI and overload probability ----------
summ <- do.call(rbind, lapply(slots, function(s) {
  x <- d$arrivals[d$time_interval == s]; m <- length(x); S <- sum(x)
  data.frame(slot = s, m = m, total = S, lambda = S / m, var = var(x),
             ci_low = qchisq(ALPHA / 2, 2 * S) / (2 * m), ci_high = qchisq(1 - ALPHA / 2, 2 * S + 2) / (2 * m))
}))
summ$p_over      <- ppois(C, summ$lambda, lower.tail = FALSE)          # P(X > C) = 1 - P(X <= C)
summ$p_over_low  <- ppois(C, summ$ci_low, lower.tail = FALSE)
summ$p_over_high <- ppois(C, summ$ci_high, lower.tail = FALSE)
summ$risk <- ifelse(summ$p_over < LOW, "Low", ifelse(summ$p_over > HIGH, "High", "Medium"))

# ---- Goodness of fit: chi-square with categories merged until E >= 5 (Cochran), and dispersion test ----
gof_test <- function(x, min_exp = 5) {
  n <- length(x); lam <- mean(x)
  kmax <- max(max(x), qpois(1e-12, lam, lower.tail = FALSE)) + 1
  prob <- function(lo, hi) if (is.infinite(hi)) ppois(lo - 1, lam, lower.tail = FALSE) else
    ppois(hi, lam) - ppois(lo - 1, lam)
  singles <- c(lapply(0:(kmax - 1), function(k) c(k, k)), list(c(kmax, Inf)))
  groups <- list(); cur <- NULL
  for (s in singles) {
    cur <- if (is.null(cur)) s else c(cur[1], s[2])
    if (n * prob(cur[1], cur[2]) >= min_exp) { groups[[length(groups) + 1]] <- cur; cur <- NULL }
  }
  if (!is.null(cur)) groups[[length(groups)]][2] <- cur[2]      # leftover right tail joins the last group
  E <- sapply(groups, function(g) n * prob(g[1], g[2]))
  O <- sapply(groups, function(g) sum(x >= g[1] & x <= g[2]))
  chi2 <- sum((O - E)^2 / E); df <- length(groups) - 2
  list(lambda = lam, chi2 = chi2, df = df, p = pchisq(chi2, df, lower.tail = FALSE), k = length(groups))
}
disp_test <- function(x) {
  m <- length(x); D <- (m - 1) * var(x) / mean(x)
  c(index = var(x) / mean(x), D = D, p = min(1, 2 * min(pchisq(D, m - 1), pchisq(D, m - 1, lower.tail = FALSE))))
}
fits <- lapply(slots, function(s) gof_test(d$arrivals[d$time_interval == s]))
summ$gof_p  <- sapply(fits, `[[`, "p")
summ$disp_p <- sapply(slots, function(s) disp_test(d$arrivals[d$time_interval == s])["p"])
```

```r
rejections  <- sum(summ$gof_p <= ALPHA)
binom_p     <- pbinom(rejections - 1, K, ALPHA, lower.tail = FALSE)   # P(at least
↪  this many | all Poisson)

# ---- Least-crowded slot: exact conditional test against the runner-up
↪  ----------------------------
ranked <- summ[order(summ$lambda, summ$slot), ]
best <- ranked[1, ]; runner <- ranked[2, ]
quiet_p <- pbinom(best$total, best$total + runner$total, best$m / (best$m +
↪  runner$m))

# ---- Capacity planning: smallest C with P(X > C) below a target
↪  --------------------------------
required_capacity <- function(lam, target) {
  c <- max(1, qpois(1 - target, lam)); while (ppois(c, lam, lower.tail = FALSE) >=
↪  target) c <- c + 1; c }
summ$need20 <- sapply(summ$lambda, required_capacity, target = LOW)
peak <- summ[which.max(summ$lambda), ]; worst <- summ[which.max(summ$p_over), ]
# ---- Day-specific forecast: multiple linear regression on log counts
↪  ------------------------------
fit_model <- function(dd) {
  dd$slot <- factor(dd$time_interval, levels = sort(unique(dd$time_interval)))
  dd$dayf <- factor(dd$day, levels = DAYS[DAYS %in% dd$day])
  types   <- unique(dd$day_type)
  dd$typef <- factor(dd$day_type, levels = c(intersect("Regular", types),
↪  sort(setdiff(types, "Regular"))))
  # a day type that coincides with whole days of the week (e.g. Weekend = Saturday +
  ↪  Sunday) is already
  # captured by the day terms, so it gets no term of its own
  nested <- all(tapply(dd$day_type, dd$dayf, function(z) length(unique(z)) == 1))
  terms <- c("slot", if (nlevels(dd$dayf) > 1) "dayf", if (nlevels(dd$typef) > 1 &&
↪  !nested) "typef")
  f <- lm(as.formula(paste("log(arrivals + 0.5) ~", paste(terms, collapse = " +
↪  "))), data = dd)
  smear <- mean(exp(resid(f)))                                  # Duan's smearing
↪  factor
  mu <- pmax(exp(fitted(f)) * smear - 0.5, 0.05)
  pearson <- sum((dd$arrivals - mu)^2 / mu)                     # Pearson
↪  chi-square, df = n - p
  v <- max((pearson - df.residual(f)) / sum(mu), 0)             # day-to-day
↪  variance Var(W)
  list(fit = f, smear = smear, mu = mu, v = v, pearson = pearson, dof =
  ↪  df.residual(f),
       slots = levels(dd$slot), days = levels(dd$dayf), types = levels(dd$typef),
       ↪  data = dd)
}
predict_day <- function(m, weekday, type = "Regular", at = m$slots) {
  nd <- data.frame(slot = factor(at, levels = m$slots), dayf = factor(weekday,
↪  levels = m$days),
```

```
                    typef = factor(type, levels = m$types))
  setNames(pmax(exp(predict(m$fit, nd)) * m$smear - 0.5, 0.05), at)
}
p_over_mixed <- function(lam, C, v) if (v <= 1e-6) ppois(C, lam, lower.tail = FALSE)
↪  else
  pnbinom(C, size = 1 / v, mu = lam, lower.tail = FALSE)          # Poisson-Gamma =
  ↪  negative binomial

M <- fit_model(d)
v <- M$v
disp_p <- pchisq(M$pearson, M$dof, lower.tail = FALSE)
summ$p_mixed <- p_over_mixed(summ$lambda, C, v)
coefs <- summary(M$fit)$coefficients
r2 <- summary(M$fit)$r.squared; adj_r2 <- summary(M$fit)$adj.r.squared

# ---- Day effects on daily totals: ANOVA / Kruskal-Wallis (weekday), Welch t /
↪  Mann-Whitney (special days) ---
daily <- aggregate(arrivals ~ date + day + day_type, data = d, FUN = function(x)
↪  c(sum = sum(x), n = length(x)))
daily <- data.frame(daily[1:3], total = daily$arrivals[, "sum"], n =
↪  daily$arrivals[, "n"])
daily <- daily[daily$n == K, ]
reg_days <- daily[daily$day_type == "Regular", ]
aov_w <- oneway.test(total ~ day, data = reg_days, var.equal = TRUE)
kw_w  <- kruskal.test(total ~ day, data = reg_days)
has_exam <- any(daily$day_type != "Regular")
special <- paste(sort(unique(daily$day_type[daily$day_type != "Regular"])), collapse
↪  = "/")
if (has_exam) {
  t_e <- t.test(daily$total[daily$day_type != "Regular"], reg_days$total, var.equal
↪  = FALSE)
  u_e <- wilcox.test(daily$total[daily$day_type != "Regular"], reg_days$total, exact
↪  = FALSE)
}

# ---- Peak-time probability by simulation, and P(at least one overload)
↪  -------------------------
peak_sim <- function(mu, v, n = 20000, seed = 2026) {
  set.seed(seed)
  W <- if (v > 1e-6) rgamma(n, shape = 1 / v, rate = 1 / v) else rep(1, n)
  X <- matrix(rpois(n * length(mu), outer(W, mu)), n, length(mu))
  pk <- max.col(X + matrix(runif(length(X), 0, 0.5), n), ties.method = "first")
  list(p_peak = setNames(tabulate(pk, length(mu)) / n, names(mu)),
       p_any = mean(rowSums(X > C) > 0), expected = mean(rowSums(X > C)))
}
cases <- data.frame(day = c("Monday", "Friday"), type = c("Regular", "Regular"))
if ("Weekend" %in% M$types && "Saturday" %in% M$days) cases <- rbind(cases,
↪  data.frame(day = "Saturday", type = "Weekend"))
```

```r
if ("Exam" %in% M$types) cases <- rbind(cases, data.frame(day = "Monday", type =
↪  "Exam"))
fc <- lapply(seq_len(nrow(cases)), function(i) {
  mu <- predict_day(M, cases$day[i], cases$type[i]); s <- peak_sim(mu, v)
  c(list(mu = mu, p = p_over_mixed(mu, C, v)), s) })
mon <- fc[[1]]
top2 <- names(sort(mon$p_peak, decreasing = TRUE))[1:2]

# ---- Same-day Bayesian update: Gamma prior on the busyness factor W
↪  --------------------------------
mu_mon <- mon$mu; k_seen <- max(1, min(2, K %/% 2))
obs_seen <- round(mu_mon[1:k_seen] * 1.15)                          # a morning 15%
↪  busier than forecast
a <- 1 / max(v, 1e-6)
post_shape <- a + sum(obs_seen); post_rate <- a + sum(mu_mon[1:k_seen])
rest <- mu_mon[-(1:k_seen)]
upd <- data.frame(slot = names(rest), mu = rest, before = p_over_mixed(rest, C, v),
                  after = pnbinom(C, size = post_shape, prob = post_rate /
                  ↪  (post_rate + rest), lower.tail = FALSE))
# ---- Validation: forecast each day from earlier days only (expanding window, first
↪  30 days training) ----
TRAIN <- min(30, n_days %/% 2); UPD <- max(1, min(2, K %/% 2))   # first half of the
↪  record trains the model
dates <- sort(unique(d$date))
set.seed(7)
rows <- list(); days_out <- list()
for (i in (TRAIN + 1):length(dates)) {
  train <- d[d$date < dates[i], ]; test <- d[d$date == dates[i], ]; test <-
↪  test[order(test$time_interval), ]
  m <- fit_model(train)
  if (!test$day[1] %in% m$days) next
  type <- if (test$day_type[1] %in% m$types) test$day_type[1] else "Regular"   #
↪  unseen day type -> regular
  base_all <- tapply(train$arrivals, train$time_interval, mean)
  test <- test[test$time_interval %in% m$slots & test$time_interval %in%
↪  names(base_all), ]
  x <- test$arrivals; mu <- predict_day(m, test$day[1], type, test$time_interval)
  base <- as.numeric(base_all[test$time_interval]); vv <- m$v
  cdf <- function(q) if (vv <= 1e-6) ppois(q, mu) else pnbinom(q, size = 1 / vv, mu
↪  = mu)
  qf  <- function(p) if (vv <= 1e-6) qpois(p, mu) else qnbinom(p, size = 1 / vv, mu
↪  = mu)
  pit <- cdf(x - 1) + runif(length(x)) * (cdf(x) - cdf(x - 1))      # randomised PIT
↪  for counts
  p_upd <- rep(NA, length(x)); kk <- min(UPD, length(x) - 1)
  aa <- 1 / max(vv, 1e-6); sh <- aa + sum(x[1:kk]); rt <- aa + sum(mu[1:kk])
  p_upd[-(1:kk)] <- pnbinom(C, size = sh, prob = rt / (rt + mu[-(1:kk)]), lower.tail
↪  = FALSE)
```

```
  rows[[length(rows) + 1]] <- data.frame(
    date = dates[i], actual = x, mu = mu, base = base, p_model = p_over_mixed(mu, C,
    ↪  vv),
    p_base = ppois(C, base, lower.tail = FALSE), p_upd = p_upd, over = as.numeric(x
    ↪  > C),
    covered = as.numeric(x >= qf(0.025) & x <= qf(0.975)), pit = pit)
  days_out[[length(days_out) + 1]] <- data.frame(
    date = dates[i], day = test$day[1], day_type = test$day_type[1],
    mae_model = mean(abs(x - mu)), mae_base = mean(abs(x - base)),
    hit = x[which.max(mu)] == max(x), n_tied = sum(x == max(x)), n_slots =
    ↪  length(x))
}
S <- do.call(rbind, rows); Dd <- do.call(rbind, days_out)

brier <- function(p, o) mean((p - o)^2)
B_model <- brier(S$p_model, S$over); B_base <- brier(S$p_base, S$over)
U <- S[!is.na(S$p_upd), ]
B_upd <- brier(U$p_upd, U$over); B_noupd <- brier(U$p_model, U$over)
ztest <- function(succ, n, p0, alt = "two.sided") {
  z <- (succ / n - p0) / sqrt(p0 * (1 - p0) / n)
  c(phat = succ / n, z = z, p = if (alt == "greater") pnorm(z, lower.tail = FALSE)
  ↪  else 2 * pnorm(-abs(z))) }
cov_t  <- ztest(sum(S$covered), nrow(S), 0.95)
chance <- mean(Dd$n_tied / Dd$n_slots)
hit_t  <- ztest(sum(Dd$hit), nrow(Dd), chance, "greater")
pair_t <- t.test(Dd$mae_base, Dd$mae_model, paired = TRUE, alternative = "greater")
wins <- sum(Dd$mae_base > Dd$mae_model); losses <- sum(Dd$mae_base < Dd$mae_model)
sign_t <- binom.test(wins, wins + losses, 0.5, alternative = "greater")
ks_t   <- ks.test(S$pit, "punif")
pit_counts <- table(cut(S$pit, seq(0, 1, 0.1), include.lowest = TRUE))
chi_t  <- chisq.test(pit_counts)
cor_t  <- cor.test(S$mu, S$actual)
grp <- ifelse(Dd$day_type != "Regular", paste(Dd$day_type, "days"),
              ifelse(Dd$day == "Friday", "Fridays", "Other regular days"))
mae_grp <- aggregate(cbind(mae_model, mae_base) ~ grp, data = cbind(Dd, grp = grp),
↪  FUN = mean)
mae_grp$n <- as.numeric(table(grp)[mae_grp$grp])

reliability <- function(p, o) {
  b <- findInterval(p, c(0.2, 0.4, 0.6, 0.8))
  do.call(rbind, lapply(sort(unique(b)), function(i)
    data.frame(bin = i, forecast = mean(p[b == i]), observed = mean(o[b == i]), n =
    ↪  sum(b == i))))
}

# ---- Dependence checks: consecutive-slot rank correlation, runs test on daily
↪  residuals ----------
d$ratio <- d$arrivals / M$mu
```

```
wide <- reshape(d[c("date", "time_interval", "ratio")], idvar = "date", timevar =
↪  "time_interval",
                direction = "wide")
wide <- wide[, c("date", paste0("ratio.", slots))]
cons <- do.call(rbind, lapply(1:(K - 1), function(j) {
  a1 <- wide[[j + 1]]; a2 <- wide[[j + 2]]; ok <- !is.na(a1) & !is.na(a2)
  ct <- suppressWarnings(cor.test(a1[ok], a2[ok], method = "spearman"))
  data.frame(pair = paste(slot_lab(slots[j]), "->", slot_lab(slots[j + 1])), rho =
  ↪  unname(ct$estimate),
             p = ct$p.value) }))
res_day <- aggregate(cbind(arrivals, mu = M$mu) ~ date, data = cbind(d, mu = M$mu),
↪  FUN = sum)
sgn <- res_day$arrivals > res_day$mu
n1 <- sum(sgn); n2 <- sum(!sgn); runs <- 1 + sum(sgn[-1] != sgn[-length(sgn)])
runs_mean <- 2 * n1 * n2 / (n1 + n2) + 1
runs_var  <- 2 * n1 * n2 * (2 * n1 * n2 - n1 - n2) / ((n1 + n2)^2 * (n1 + n2 - 1))
runs_z <- (runs - runs_mean) / sqrt(runs_var); runs_p <- 2 * pnorm(-abs(runs_z))
tab(data.frame(Column = c("date", "day", "day_type", "time_interval", "arrivals",
↪  "capacity"),
               Meaning = c("Calendar date of the day", "Weekday (derived from the
               ↪  date)",
                           "Regular or Weekend (optional; Regular if absent)",
                           ↪  "15-minute slot, HH:MM-HH:MM",
                           "Number of students who entered in the slot", "Capacity C
                           ↪  per slot (optional)")),
    "Dataset variables")
tab(head(raw[c("date", "day", "day_type", "time_interval", "arrivals", "capacity")],
↪  5), "First five records")
ggplot(d, aes(x = factor(slot_start(time_interval), levels = slot_start(slots)), y
↪  = date, fill = arrivals)) +
  geom_tile() + scale_fill_gradient(low = "#E3F4F4", high = INK, name = "Arrivals")
  ↪  +
  scale_y_date(date_labels = "%d %b", expand = c(0, 0)) + labs(x = "Slot start
  ↪  time", y = NULL) +
  theme_report + theme(legend.position = "right", legend.title = element_text(size =
↪  9))
ggplot(summ, aes(x = factor(slot_start(slot), levels = slot_start(slots)), y =
↪  lambda)) +
  geom_col(fill = TEAL, width = 0.62) +
  geom_errorbar(aes(ymin = ci_low, ymax = ci_high), width = 0.2, colour = INK) +
  geom_hline(yintercept = C, linetype = "dashed", colour = RISK_COL["High"]) +
  annotate("text", x = K, y = C + 1.6, label = paste("capacity C =", C), hjust = 1,
  ↪  size = 3,
           colour = RISK_COL["High"]) +
  labs(x = "Slot start time", y = expression(hat(lambda)[t] ~ "(arrivals per 15
  ↪  min)")) + theme_report
xp <- d$arrivals[d$time_interval == peak$slot]
kk <- seq(min(xp) - 2, max(xp) + 2)
```

```
ggplot() + geom_col(aes(x = kk, y = sapply(kk, function(k) sum(xp == k)), fill =
↪  "Observed days"), width = 0.8) +
  geom_line(aes(x = kk, y = length(xp) * dpois(kk, mean(xp)), colour = "Poisson
  ↪  model"), linewidth = 0.8) +
  geom_point(aes(x = kk, y = length(xp) * dpois(kk, mean(xp)), colour = "Poisson
  ↪  model"), size = 1) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = SOFT) + scale_colour_manual(values = INK) +
  labs(x = paste("Arrivals in slot", slot_lab(peak$slot)), y = "Number of days") +
  ↪  theme_report
tab(data.frame(Slot = slot_lab(summ$slot), lambda = sprintf("%.2f", summ$lambda),
               CI = sprintf("[%.2f, %.2f]", summ$ci_low, summ$ci_high),
               VarMean = sprintf("%.2f", summ$var / summ$lambda), Disp =
                ↪  fmtp(summ$disp_p),
               GOF = fmtp(summ$gof_p), P = sprintf("%.2f", 100 * summ$p_over), Risk
                ↪  = summ$risk),
    "\\label{tab:slots}Per-slot estimates, Poisson checks and overload probability",
    col.names = c("Slot", "$\\hat\\lambda_t$", "95\\% CI", "Var/Mean", "Dispersion
    ↪  $p$", "$\\chi^2$ GOF $p$",
                  "$P(X_t>C)$, \\%", "Risk"), escape = FALSE, align = "lccccccc")
ggplot(summ, aes(x = factor(slot_start(slot), levels = slot_start(slots)), y = 100
↪  * p_over, fill = risk)) +
  geom_col(width = 0.62) + geom_hline(yintercept = c(20, 50), linetype = "dotted",
  ↪  colour = GREY) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = RISK_COL, breaks = c("Low", "Medium", "High")) +
  labs(x = "Slot start time", y = "P(X > C), %") + ylim(0, 100) + theme_report
cf <- data.frame(Term = sub("^slot", "Slot ", sub("^dayf", "", sub("^typef", "",
↪  rownames(coefs)))),
                 Estimate = sprintf("%.4f", coefs[, 1]), SE = sprintf("%.4f",
                  ↪  coefs[, 2]),
                 t = sprintf("%.2f", coefs[, 3]), p = fmtp(coefs[, 4]), Multiplier =
                  ↪  sprintf("%.3f", exp(coefs[, 1])))
cf$Term <- sub("^Slot (\\d\\d:\\d\\d).*", "Slot \\1", cf$Term); cf$Term[1] <-
↪  "Intercept"
cf$Term[cf$Term == "Exam"] <- "Exam week"; cf$Term[cf$Term == "Weekend"] <-
↪  "Weekend"
tab(cf, "\\label{tab:coef}Regression of $\\ln(x + 0.5)$ on slot, weekday and day
↪  type", escape = FALSE,
    col.names = c("Term", "Estimate", "SE", "$t$", "$p$", "$e^{\\hat\\beta}$"),
     ↪  align = "lrrrrr")
fd <- do.call(rbind, lapply(seq_along(fc), function(i)
  data.frame(slot = slot_start(names(fc[[i]]$mu)), p = 100 * fc[[i]]$p,
             case = paste0(cases$day[i], " (", tolower(cases$type[i]), ")"))))
ggplot(fd, aes(x = factor(slot, levels = slot_start(slots)), y = p, colour = case,
↪  group = case, shape = case)) +
  geom_line(linewidth = 0.8) + geom_point(size = 2) + scale_colour_manual(values =
  ↪  c(INK, RISK_COL[["Medium"]], TEAL)) +
  labs(x = "Slot start time", y = "Predicted P(X > C), %") + ylim(0, 100) +
  ↪  theme_report
```

```
pp <- data.frame(slot = factor(slot_start(names(mon$p_peak)), levels =
↪  slot_start(slots)), p = 100 * mon$p_peak)
ggplot(pp, aes(x = slot, y = p, fill = p == max(p))) + geom_col(width = 0.62,
↪  show.legend = FALSE) +
  geom_text(aes(label = ifelse(p >= 5, sprintf("%.0f%%", p), "")), vjust = -0.4,
  ↪  size = 3, colour = INK) +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c(`FALSE` = SOFT, `TRUE` = INK)) +
  labs(x = "Slot start time", y = "P(slot is the day's peak), %") + theme_report
tab(data.frame(Slot = slot_lab(upd$slot), Forecast = sprintf("%.1f", upd$mu), Before
↪  = esc(pct(upd$before)),
               After = esc(pct(upd$after))),
    paste0("\\label{tab:update}Overload probability of the remaining slots before
    ↪  and after observing the first ",
           ifelse(k_seen == 1, "slot", paste(k_seen, "slots"))),
    col.names = c("Remaining slot", "Forecast $\\lambda_t$", "$P(X_t>C)$ before",
    ↪  "$P(X_t>C)$ after"),
    escape = FALSE, align = "lccc")
yn <- function(ok) ifelse(ok, "Yes", "No")
tab(data.frame(
  Check = c("95\\% intervals cover actual counts", "Peak slot named correctly",
  ↪  "Lower daily error than baseline",
          "More winning days than baseline", "PIT uniform", "PIT histogram flat"),
  Test = c("$z$, one proportion", "$z$, one proportion", "Paired $t$", "Sign test",
  ↪  "Kolmogorov-Smirnov", "$\\chi^2$ GOF"),
  Statistic = c(sprintf("$z$ = %.2f", cov_t["z"]), sprintf("$z$ = %.2f",
  ↪  hit_t["z"]), sprintf("$t$ = %.2f", pair_t$statistic),
                sprintf("%d wins / %d", wins, wins + losses), sprintf("$D$ = %.3f",
                ↪  ks_t$statistic),
                sprintf("$\\chi^2$ = %.2f", chi_t$statistic)),
  p = fmtp(c(cov_t["p"], hit_t["p"], pair_t$p.value, sign_t$p.value, ks_t$p.value,
  ↪  chi_t$p.value)),
  Result = esc(c(pct(cov_t["phat"]), sprintf("%s vs %s", pct(hit_t["phat"], 0),
  ↪  pct(chance, 0)),
            sprintf("%.2f vs %.2f", mean(Dd$mae_model), mean(Dd$mae_base)),
            ↪  sprintf("%d of %d days", wins, nrow(Dd)),
            ifelse(ks_t$p.value < ALPHA, "not uniform", "uniform"),
            ↪  ifelse(chi_t$p.value < ALPHA, "not flat", "flat"))),
  OK = yn(c(cov_t["p"] >= ALPHA, hit_t["p"] < ALPHA, pair_t$p.value < ALPHA,
  ↪  sign_t$p.value < ALPHA,
          ks_t$p.value >= ALPHA, chi_t$p.value >= ALPHA)),
  "\\label{tab:valid}Hypothesis tests of the one-day-ahead forecasts (model vs
  ↪  baseline: MAE; hit rate vs chance)",
  col.names = c("Check", "Test", "Statistic", "$p$", "Result", "Supports?"), escape
  ↪  = FALSE, align = "lllrlc")
rel <- rbind(cbind(reliability(S$p_model, S$over), method = "Regression model"),
             cbind(reliability(S$p_base, S$over), method = "Per-slot average"))
ggplot(rel, aes(x = 100 * forecast, y = 100 * observed, colour = method, shape =
↪  method)) +
```

```
  geom_abline(linetype = "dotted", colour = GREY) + geom_line() + geom_point(size =
  ↪  2) +
  scale_colour_manual(values = c(TEAL, INK)) + coord_equal(xlim = c(0, 100), ylim =
  ↪  c(0, 100)) +
  labs(x = "Forecast P(X > C), %", y = "Observed overload frequency, %") +
  ↪  theme_report
ggplot(data.frame(pit = S$pit), aes(x = pit)) +
  geom_histogram(breaks = seq(0, 1, 0.1), fill = SOFT, colour = "white") +
  geom_hline(yintercept = nrow(S) / 10, linetype = "dashed", colour = INK) +
  labs(x = "PIT value", y = "Number of slot forecasts") + theme_report
tab(data.frame(Slot = slot_lab(summ$slot), Poisson = pct(summ$p_over, 2), Mixed =
↪  pct(summ$p_mixed, 2),
               Diff = sprintf("%+.2f", 100 * (summ$p_mixed - summ$p_over))),
    "\\label{tab:mix}Overload probability under the Poisson and Poisson--Gamma
    ↪  models",
    col.names = c("Slot", "Poisson", "Poisson--Gamma", "Difference (points)"), align
    ↪  = "lccc")
ggplot(Dd, aes(x = mae_base, y = mae_model, colour = day_type, shape = day_type)) +
  geom_abline(linetype = "dotted", colour = GREY) + geom_point(size = 2) +
  scale_colour_manual(values = c(Regular = TEAL, Weekend = RISK_COL[["Medium"]],
  ↪  Exam = INK)) + coord_equal() +
  labs(x = "Per-slot average: daily MAE", y = "Regression model: daily MAE") +
  ↪  theme_report
tab(data.frame(Days = mae_grp$grp, n = mae_grp$n, Model = sprintf("%.2f",
↪  mae_grp$mae_model),
               Baseline = sprintf("%.2f", mae_grp$mae_base)),
    "\\label{tab:grp}Mean absolute error by kind of day", col.names = c("Days", "n",
    ↪  "Model MAE", "Baseline MAE"))
tab(data.frame(
  Study = c("Tang et al. [21]", "Jiao et al. [11]", "Kim and Whitt [13]", "Weinberg
  ↪  et al. [24]",
            "Shen and Huang [20]", "Shah et al. [19]", "\\textbf{This project}"),
  Approach = c("Pedestrian flow in a canteen", "M/M/C simulation, one rate", "Tests
  ↪  of Poisson arrivals",
               "Bayesian rate forecasts", "Rate forecasts, intraday update", "ML
               ↪  forecast of daily totals",
               "Per-slot Poisson + regression + Bayes"),
  Over = c("No", "No", "No", "No", "No", "No", "\\textbf{Yes}"),
  Tests = c("No", "No", "Yes", "Partly", "Partly", "No", "\\textbf{Yes}"),
  Peak = c("No", "No", "No", "No", "No", "No", "\\textbf{Yes}"),
  Valid = c("No", "No", "--", "Yes", "Yes", "Yes", "\\textbf{Yes}")),
  "Comparison with existing studies", escape = FALSE, align = "llcccc",
  col.names = c("Study", "Approach", "Overload $P$", "Tests Poisson", "Peak time",
  ↪  "Unseen days"))
```